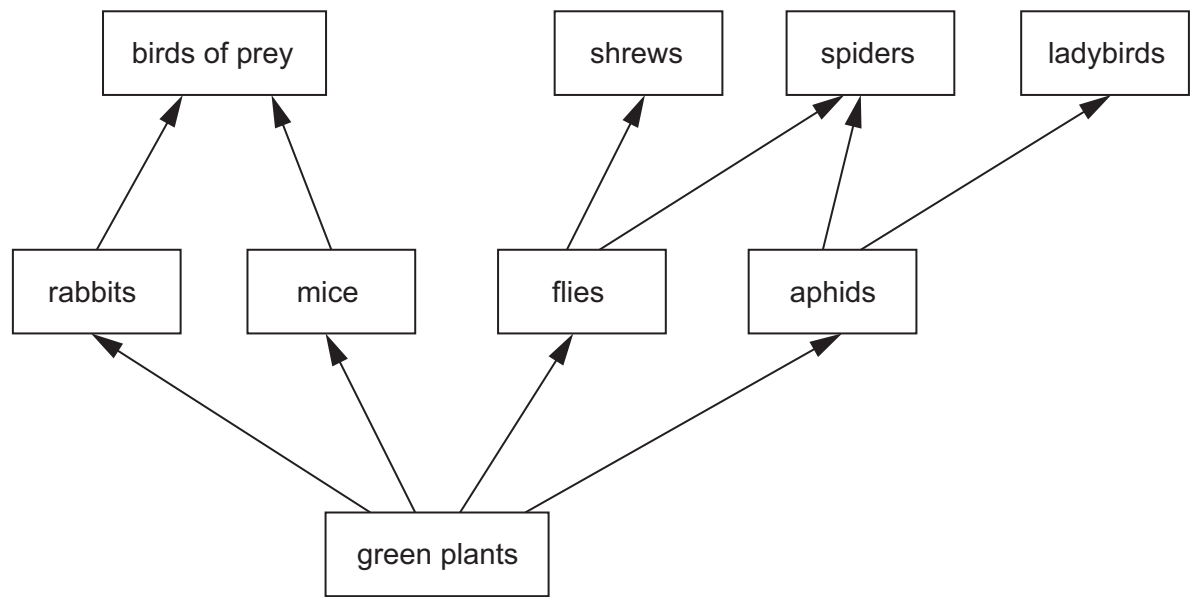


8. The diagram below shows a food web in an area of grassland.



Farmers were concerned that the rabbit population was increasing and called in a pest control company to destroy the rabbits.

(a) Identify the herbivores and second stage consumers in the food web above. Explain how the populations of each would be affected if all the rabbits were destroyed. [6 QER]

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(b) Explain how the levels of mineral nutrients in the soil would be increased if the dead bodies of rabbits were not removed by the pest control company. [2]

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